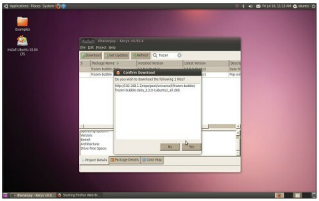

Figure 5: Download confirmation dialogue

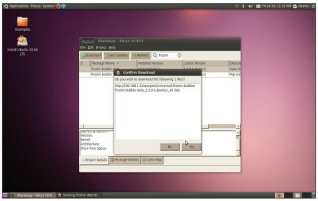

Figure 6: Installable packages list

since we are using a Debian-based system. Click the *New Project* button to create the project. Keryx now collects data about the base system, and stores it in the project folder. Alternately, you can create the project via the command-line, using the command given below:

```
$ ./keryx -create projectname debian
```

In my case, the collected project information is stored at */usbdisk/keryx-0.92.1/project/ubuntu* (in the Keryx folder itself).

The Keryx site also offers pre-made projects, made with fresh installs of Ubuntu GNU/Linux, from version 8.10. You could use one of these to save this initial step, if your system has a fresh installation of one of these Ubuntu versions.

3. Downloading: With the project created, we are ready to download packages. Eject the USB drive from the base system, and plug it into the online system.

   For Linux hosts, mount the flash drive, and start the program as discussed above.

   For Mac hosts to run Keryx, you will need wxPython installed on the system. You can get it from http://www.wxpython.org/download.php#binaries. After installing wxPython, start Keryx by executing *keryx.py* in the source folder of the main Keryx folder.

   For Windows hosts, just double-click *keryx.exe* in the *win32* folder of the main Keryx folder.

   Users behind a proxy will have to configure their connection options, at *Edit > Options > Download Options*.
4. Open your project, and download the package lists: When Keryx starts, the welcome screen will greet you with the choice of opening a project or creating a new one. Select your project name from the drop-down list, and open it. Keryx will then ask you to confirm the download of the package lists (see Figure 2). Click Yes, and wait while Keryx refreshes package lists. After that, Keryx will present you with a Synaptic-like interface, where you can choose new packages to download. (See Figure 3.)
5. Downloading packages: To install a program, say the popular Frozen-Bubble game, type 'frozen' into the search box on the main window (see Figure 4). Right-click the frozen-bubble item, and select the download option. You will have to confirm the download of dependent packages (see Figure 5) before the download starts. Keryx only allows you to download a single package (and its dependencies) at a time, but you can consecutively download as many packages as you can carry on your pen drive. When you're done downloading packages, eject the USB drive, and unplug it.
6. Installing downloaded packages on the base system: Now plug your flash drive into the base system, and fire up Keryx. Click on *Projects > Install Packages*. A window will open, which lists packages on the pen drive (see Figure 6). You can select which packages to install, and click *Continue*. Keryx will install the packages onto your base system. After installation, we need to update our project files, since new packages have been added to the base system. To do this, click *Project > Update Status* in the main Keryx interface.

Updating your distribution

Updating your distribution regularly is recommended, both for security, and for the smooth running of the system. You can use Keryx to update your system too! On the host system, start Keryx, and open your project. Click the *Get Updates* button on the main window, and Keryx will start downloading updates for your distribution. You can install the downloaded updates on your base system using the method described in Step 6. Again, after installation, don't forget to update your project with the changed package status, as mentioned in the same Step 6.

Happy hacking. END

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The author is a huge FOSS enthusiast who loves to read, travel, and hack python and avr microcontrollers. The three projects he feels he can't live without are: Archlinux, Emacs and KDE.